

Incident Lifecycle Automation in ServiceNow

PHASE 4: PLANNING

Project Detail	Information
Domain	Information Technology
Project Type	Individual Project
Platform	ServiceNow
Primary Area	IT Service Management (ITSM)
Project Scenario	Corporate VPN incident lifecycle from creation to resolution

Prepared as part of the seven-phase project documentation

1. Phase Overview

The planning phase organizes the project into manageable work so that the ServiceNow implementation can be completed and demonstrated in a controlled way. Because this is an individual project, planning is especially important: the same person is responsible for configuration, testing, evidence collection, documentation, version control, and the final demonstration.

2. Project Scope Plan

The planned scope is to demonstrate the complete lifecycle of a Corporate VPN incident. The project will not attempt to redesign every ServiceNow ITSM process. Instead, it will focus on the records and interactions needed to show a realistic incident journey from the first report to final validation.

- Service and service offering setup for Remote Access and Corporate VPN.
- Incident creation and classification.
- Knowledge search / Agent Assist during initial troubleshooting.
- Assignment and escalation from Service Desk to Network / Level 2.
- Technical investigation and work-note updates.
- Emergency change linkage where the scenario requires a technical change.
- Child incident creation for a related user or occurrence.
- Resolution and probable-cause documentation.
- Knowledge article creation from the final solution.
- SLA and related-record validation.

3. Work Breakdown Structure

Work package	Planned activities	Expected output
WP1 - Environment preparation	Verify instance access, required roles, users, groups, and sample data.	A usable ServiceNow environment for development and testing.
WP2 - Service context	Create or verify Remote Access and Corporate VPN records.	Service hierarchy available for the incident.
WP3 - Incident setup	Create incident and configure classification values.	A complete initial incident record.
WP4 - Knowledge support	Search and review relevant knowledge using the available workspace tools.	Knowledge evidence attached or referenced during troubleshooting.
WP5 - Escalation and investigation	Reassign to Network / Level 2 and document technical findings.	Traceable ownership change and investigation notes.
WP6 - Change and related incidents	Create emergency change and child incident where required.	Linked records visible from the incident.
WP7 - Resolution and knowledge capture	Record cause and resolution, resolve records, create knowledge article.	Resolved incident and reusable knowledge output.
WP8 - Validation and evidence	Review SLA, related lists, statuses, and capture screenshots.	End-to-end test evidence.
WP9 - Submission preparation	Prepare phase documents, GitHub repository, and demo link.	Complete mentor-review package.

4. Suggested Timeline

The actual project may already be implemented, but the following schedule is a clean way to describe how the work can be planned. It can be adjusted to match the dates used by the institution.

Period	Focus	Main outputs
Week 1	Ideation and requirements	Problem statement, empathy map, requirements, scope.
Week 2	Design and planning	Process design, data relationships, milestone plan, test approach.
Week 3	ServiceNow setup and incident build	Service hierarchy, incident creation, classification, knowledge checks.
Week 4	Escalation, change, child incident, resolution	Network handoff, linked change, child incident, resolved records.
Week 5	Knowledge, validation, and documentation	Knowledge article, SLA checks, screenshots, test results.
Week 6	Demo and submission packaging	GitHub repository, demo video/link, final phase documents.

5. Role and Responsibility Plan

Role in scenario	Responsibility
Project owner / ServiceNow administrator	Configures the project, prepares sample data, performs testing, and maintains documentation.
End user / caller	Provides the VPN issue that starts the incident lifecycle.
Service Desk analyst	Creates or reviews the incident, classifies it, checks knowledge, and escalates when needed.
Network / Level 2 technician	Performs deeper technical investigation and records findings.
Change participant	Creates, reviews, or processes the emergency change when the solution requires it.
Evaluator / mentor	Reviews evidence and checks whether the project can be explained and demonstrated end to end.

6. Resource Plan

Resource	Planned use
ServiceNow instance	Primary environment for configuration and demonstration.
Web browser	Access to the ServiceNow workspace and project submission platform.
Project documentation tool	Preparation of phase documents and final report material.
Screen capture / recording tool	Creation of screenshots and the final demo video if required.
GitHub repository	Storage of README, screenshots, documentation, and non-sensitive project assets.

7. Test Plan

Testing is planned as a sequence of checkpoints rather than a single final test. Each major record should be verified immediately after it is created, and the complete scenario should then be repeated as an end-to-end test.

Test area	Planned verification
Service hierarchy	Confirm Remote Access and Corporate VPN can be selected and are correctly related.
Incident fields	Confirm description, category, subcategory, urgency, service, assignment, and other required fields are saved.
Knowledge	Confirm knowledge search or Agent Assist is available and a relevant article can be reviewed.
Assignment	Confirm the incident can move from Service Desk to Network / Level 2.
Change linkage	Confirm the change record is related to the incident.
Child incident	Confirm the child record is linked to the parent and can be tracked separately.
Resolution	Confirm cause and resolution information can be recorded and the incident can be resolved.
Knowledge creation	Confirm a final article can be created from the verified solution.
SLA / related records	Confirm final validation information is visible.

8. Risk Management Plan

Risk	Impact	Mitigation
Developer/training instance is reclaimed or unavailable	Project access may be lost before evaluation.	Keep screenshots, exported configuration where appropriate, and documentation outside the instance.
A feature is not enabled in the current workspace	The exact demonstration step may not match the document.	Use the available equivalent UI and document the limitation instead of claiming unavailable functionality.
Insufficient permissions	Change, knowledge, or impersonation steps may fail.	Verify roles before the demo and avoid last-minute permission changes.
Sensitive information is uploaded to GitHub	Credentials or private data could be exposed.	Use sample data and review files before publishing. Never upload passwords or tokens.
Demo depends on too many manual steps	The mentor may see inconsistent results.	Practice a repeatable sequence and prepare a reset or sample-record strategy.
Documentation claims more than the implementation	Evaluation credibility may be reduced.	Separate planned requirements from completed features and demonstrate only what exists.

9. Deployment and Submission Plan

For an academic project, deployment can mean two things. First, ServiceNow configuration may be moved to another instance using an Update Set or another supported application deployment method. Second, the project must be packaged for mentor review. The submission package should therefore include the project documentation, screenshots, a demo link, and a GitHub repository. If the project is moved between instances, the configuration should be previewed and tested again because demonstration data such as incidents may need to be recreated separately.

10. Planned Deliverables

- Seven separate phase documents: Ideation, Requirement Analysis, Design, Planning, Development, Documentation, and Demonstration.
- ServiceNow implementation evidence with screenshots of the important lifecycle stages.
- Test-case and validation evidence.
- GitHub repository with README and non-sensitive project assets.
- Demo video or live demo link for mentor evaluation.
- Final project description consistent with what is actually implemented.

11. Phase Conclusion

The planning phase turns the project into a practical sequence of work packages, responsibilities, tests, risks, and deliverables. This plan supports both the technical implementation and the academic submission. It also reduces the chance that the final demonstration becomes a collection of disconnected records by ensuring that every activity supports the end-to-end incident story.